

The events sheet

One tab. One row per event. Row 1 is the header. Twenty-two columns, two of them required — filled by hand, so it is built to be short.

- 1 The script reads **by header name, not by position**. Names are matched lower-cased and trimmed, unknown columns are ignored, and column order does not matter — moving or inserting a column never breaks anything.
- 2 An empty cell means **“not known yet”**, never “no”. The calendar hides what it does not know rather than printing something wrong.
- 3 **Row order in the sheet is irrelevant**. The calendar always sorts by `Start Date`, earliest first, and puts every event with an empty `Start Date` into “Dates to be confirmed” at the foot of the feed. Sort the sheet however suits you.

There is no ID column

Every event's web address is built from its **Title**. That keeps the sheet to things a human would actually type — but it has one consequence worth knowing: **rename an event and its link changes**. Anyone who bookmarked or shared the old link lands on “not in the calendar”.

So fix typos freely before you announce an event, and treat the title as settled afterwards.

The columns

In the order they should sit in the sheet: the ones you need first are first, so a row can be filled left to right and abandoned as soon as it is useful.

01 Status RECOMMENDED DROPDOWN

Whether members can see this row yet.

- **Published** Live on the calendar. This exact word, and nothing else, publishes a row.
- **Draft** You are still writing it. Nobody sees it.
- **Cancelled** It was announced and it is not happening. Removed from the calendar.

A blank cell counts as Draft. Publishing is opt-in: start a row, fill it in over a week if you like, and nobody sees it until you choose **Published**. A typo does not publish either — **Publised** is not **Published**, and the calendar reports it rather than swallowing it.

The one exception is a sheet with **no Status column at all**, which publishes every row: there is nothing to opt into, and hiding the whole calendar would be absurd. It is the presence of the column that turns the rule on.

02 Type REQUIRED DROPDOWN

What kind of event it is. Drives the colour, the label and the filter tabs across the top of the calendar.

- **Learning event** A speaker teaching something — online or in a room.
- **Forum test drive** A sample forum session for prospective members.
- **Chapter in-person** The chapter's own gatherings: retreats, dinners, chapter days.
- **Global / Regional** Anything EO runs above chapter level — GLC, ELC, Unlimited, Presidents Meeting.
- **Social** Purely social. No agenda, no speaker.

Anything else is published as written but styled neutral grey, and sits outside the filters.

03 Title REQUIRED

Exactly what a member should read. Printed verbatim — so nothing parenthetical, no status notes, no “TBC”.

- ✓ European Leadership Conference (ELC) 2026
- ✓ How to Write and Publish a Book
- ✓ Forum Test Drive – October · for a session that repeats, put what tells them apart in the title
- ✗ Joe Gregory · that is the speaker. It goes in Speaker Name
- ✗ Chapter Retreat (waiting for dates) · leave Start Date empty instead
- ✗ Placeholder event · set Status to Draft

04 Start Date REQUIRED ONCE KNOWN

The day the event begins, written YYYY-MM-DD .

- ✓ 2026-09-16 · a one-day event on 16 September 2026
- ✓ 2026-10-06 · a three-day conference starting 6 October
- ✓ (empty) · the date is genuinely not fixed yet — see below

Format the date and time columns as plain text first — Format → Number → Plain text. Otherwise Sheets rewrites 2026-10-06 into 06/10/2026 for whoever opens it next, and the parser sees something other than what you typed.

05 End Date

Only when the event runs across more than one day. YYYY-MM-DD .

- ✓ (empty) · a single-day event. Do not repeat the start date
- ✓ 2026-10-08 · a conference running 6–8 October
- ✓ 2027-01-02 · a retreat that crosses new year, 30 Dec – 2 Jan

A multi-day event is **one row**, never one row per day. The calendar counts the days itself and prints “3 days”.

06 Start Time

When it begins, local to the event. HH:MM , 24-hour.

- ✓ 15:30 · half past three in the afternoon
- ✓ 09:00
- ✓ (empty) · a multi-day event where the time varies by day — put the schedule in Description
- ✗ 3:30pm · 15 30 · 15:30 CET · the timezone has its own column

07 End Time

Useful only on a single-day event — it is what produces “90 minutes” on the page. **HH:MM** , 24-hour.

- ✓ **17:00** · a session running 15:30–17:00
- ✓ *(empty)* · open-ended, or multi-day

08 Timezone

The short code the time is given in. Empty is assumed to be **CET** .

Fill it in whenever the event is not on European time — a member reading from Kyiv or Toronto is otherwise guessing. **CET** · **EET** · **JST**

09 Date Note

One short phrase, and **only** for events with no **Start Date** yet. It is the difference between “we have no idea” and “hold the spring”.

- ✓ **Expected spring 2027**
- ✓ **Dates announced in January**
- ✓ **Two sessions, autumn**

Leave it empty on any event that has a real date — it is not shown there.

10 Location **RECOMMENDED**

Where it physically is, as a member would say it.

- ✓ **Krakow, Poland** · **Kyiv, Ukraine** · city first, then country
- ✓ **Online** · this one word switches the icon and the wording everywhere, including “joining link sent when you register”
- ✓ *(empty)* · not chosen yet. The card says “Venue TBC”

The card shows the city on its own, so put the city first.

11 Venue

The specific place — shown only on the event page, for a member who has already decided and now needs to get there.

SITUATION	WHAT TO WRITE
A hotel, restaurant or office	Sheraton Grand Kraków, Powiśle 7 — name first, then street
A conference centre	ICE Kraków Congress Centre
Online	The platform: Zoom , Google Meet , Microsoft Teams . Not the joining link — that comes from registration
A retreat across a resort or a whole town	Leave empty. Location already says it
Booked, but not announced publicly	Address sent on registration
Someone's home or a private space	Address sent on registration — never a private address in a public calendar
Not booked yet	Leave empty. The page falls back to Location

12 Summary RECOMMENDED

One sentence, 120 characters or fewer. It is the line under the photograph on the feed card — and for most members, the only sentence they read.

Write the reason to come, not a restatement of the title.

- ✓ Europe's chapter leadership, together for three days in Kraków.
- ✓ Ninety minutes inside a real EO forum — the format, not a description of it.
- ✓ Six days in Malta with the chapter — the one that sets the tone for the year.
- ✗ Join us for our upcoming learning event! · says nothing
- ✗ The first line of the description, pasted in · it reads as a truncation

Plain sentence, no HTML — the card clamps it to two lines.

13 Description TEXT OR HTML

The full text. Shown only on the event page and never truncated there, so write as much as it deserves.

Plain text works. A blank line starts a new paragraph; a single newline is a line break. Nothing else needed.

HTML also works — paste it into the cell and it renders. Supported tags:

```
<p> <br> <strong> <em> <u> <ul> <ol> <li> <a href> <h3> <h4> <blockquote> <hr>
```

Pasting formatted text straight out of Google Docs or Word works too — the paragraphs survive.

You cannot break the page with this cell. Anything outside the list above is stripped and its words kept, so a stray `<div>` or `<span>` costs you nothing. Scripts, styles, images and event handlers are removed entirely. Links open in a new tab automatically.

EXAMPLE CELL

```
<p>Three days, 300 founders, one of Europe's most beautiful cities.</p>
<h3>What the three days look like</h3>
<ul>
  <li>Main-stage speakers, each a founder who has done the thing</li>
  <li>Deep dives <em>chosen by the attendees</em></li>
</ul>
<p>Full agenda on the <a href="https://eonetwork.org/unlimited">EO Unlimited site</a>.</p>
```

14 Highlights

The ticked “What you get out of it” list. **One per line inside the one cell** — press `⌘↵` on a Mac, `Alt+Enter` on Windows, to add a line without leaving the cell.

Four is the sweet spot. Write outcomes, not agenda items.

```
Which ideas carry a book and which do not
Ghostwriting, hybrid and self-publishing – real costs and timelines
What publication actually does for inbound and speaking
The first three steps to take this month
```

Leave it empty and the section is not shown at all. That is fine — better nothing than four vague lines.

15 Who For

One sentence naming who should come, so nobody registers for the wrong room.

- ✓ Founders considering a book, and anyone already stuck mid-draft.
- ✓ Chapter board members and chapter staff.
- ✓ All EO members. Bring your partner.
- ✓ Prospective members only.

16 Speaker Name

The person's name, and nothing else.

- ✓ Joe Gregory
- ✓ Anna Koval and Dmytro Sydorenko · two speakers
- ✓ (empty) · a conference, a retreat, a social. The speaker block is simply not shown
- ✗ Joe Gregory, the Authority Company, part of Forbes Books · the rest belongs in Speaker Title

17 Speaker Title

Their role and company on one line, exactly as they would introduce themselves. Shown underneath the name.

- ✓ Founder, The Authority Company
- ✓ CEO, Fasto · EO Kyiv
- ✓ Partner, Sayenko Kharenko

18 Speaker Bio

One or two sentences: the reason to trust this person on this topic. Not a CV.

- ✓ Has taken hundreds of founders from “I should write something” to a printed book.
- ✗ A paragraph of career history

19 Guests Welcome ☒

Tick it when a member may bring a prospective member or a partner.

It puts a “Guests welcome” chip on the card and a line in the details. Unticked means no — this is the one column where an empty cell means “no” rather than “not known”, because a checkbox has no third state.

20 Registration URL RECOMMENDED

The full `https://` link that registers a member. It sits behind every Register button — on the feed, the list and the event page.

Optional. Events are often announced before registration opens, and some never have a form at all. Leave it empty and the button becomes **Add to Google Calendar** — or, once the event has a calendar entry, the invitation form. It is never a button that goes nowhere.

- An EO registration page, an Eventbrite link, a Google Form, a Typeform: all fine
- **Registration not open yet** → leave it empty and fill it in when it opens
- A `mailto:` address works, but a form is better — you get the attendee list for free

21 Image URL RECOMMENDED

A link to the picture **file**, not to the page it sits on. If the link does not end in `.jpg`, `.png` or `.webp`, or does not open the picture on its own, it will not load.

SOURCE	HOW
Unsplash	Right-click the photo → Copy image address. <code>images.unsplash.com/photo-15223832...?w=1600&q=70</code>
Wikimedia Commons	Use the “Original file” link. Wikimedia only serves <i>certain</i> widths — <code>1280px-</code> works, <code>1600px-</code> fails
Your own photo	Upload somewhere that serves files directly. A Google Drive share link will not work — it serves a viewer page

Landscape, at least 1200px wide, with the interesting part in the **upper half** — the lower half sits under a frosted band carrying the date, place and title.

Leave it empty and the card falls back to a stock image chosen by `Type`. It looks fine; it just does not look like the event.

22 Notes

Internal. Never rendered anywhere.

Anything you do not want a member to read goes here and nowhere else — who is chasing the venue, what the budget is, why the date moved.

Events whose dates are not confirmed

Leave `Start Date` empty. That is the whole mechanism. The event drops out of the dated feed and appears in “Dates to be confirmed” at the bottom, as a compact row carrying its type, title, location and a *Register interest* button.

Fill in everything else you know — `Title` , `Type` , `Location` , `Summary` , `Registration URL` — and add a `Date Note` if you can say roughly when. When the date lands, type it into `Start Date` and the event moves into the feed on its own.

Do not write “TBC” into the `Title` or “TBD” into `Start Date`. **Both are printed to members.**

What the current sheet has to change

Ten differences between the file as it stands and the standard above. Each one is something the parser repairs at read time today and records as a data issue — twenty-seven of them at the last run.

TODAY	BECOMES	WHY
<code>Name</code> holds the speaker on learning events and the title on everything else	<code>Title</code> and <code>Speaker Name</code> , always the same meaning	The single biggest trap. Read literally, five events are titled with a person's name and have no description at all
<code>Description</code> holds the title on learning events	<code>Description</code> is always the description	The other half of the same trap
<code>Start Date</code> = 18 May, no year anywhere in the file	<code>Start Date</code> = 2026-05-18	Removes a year inference that has already been wrong twice
<code>Time</code> = 15 00 CET, 3:30 – 5:00pm	<code>Start Time</code> , <code>End Time</code> , <code>Timezone</code>	Three facts in one cell cannot be sorted, filtered or converted
<code>Audience</code> , free text, searched for the phrase “leads could be invited”	<code>Guests Welcome</code> checkbox	A phrase match breaks the moment somebody rewords the sentence
speaker, role and company in one cell	<code>Speaker Name</code> + <code>Speaker Title</code>	The card needs the name alone; the page needs both
<code>Place</code> blank on online events	<code>Location</code> = Online	Blank means “not known”. Online is known
“(waiting for dates)” written inside the title	empty <code>Start Date</code> + <code>Date Note</code>	The title is printed to members exactly as typed
no registration link anywhere in the file	<code>Registration URL</code>	The calendar exists to produce this click
<code>Types</code> and <code>Comments</code> , both unused	<code>Notes</code>	One internal column, clearly named, never rendered

How the script reads it

```
GET https://sheets.googleapis.com/v4/spreadsheets/{SPREADSHEET_ID}/values/{TAB}!A1:Z
?key={API_KEY}
```

The sheet has to be shared as **Anyone with the link → Viewer**; an API key cannot open a private sheet. The response is a `values` array with row 0 as the header — map those names to the columns above and everything downstream is unchanged.

A checkbox comes back as the string `TRUE` or `FALSE`. A dropdown comes back as its plain label.

EO Ukraine community calendar · sheet standard v1 · 22 columns · the parser that consumes it lives in
mocks/_normalize.py